



GLOBAL GOVERNANCE FRAMEWORKS · TIER 3 CROSS-CUTTING
PROTOCOL

Adaptive Coordination Protocol

*A lightweight, voluntary coordination mechanism designed to align
national sovereignty with global systemic needs during cross-border crises.*

V0.5

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Status: Ready for Practitioner Review

Adaptive Coordination Protocol (ACP)

Tier 3 (Cross-Cutting Protocol)

Status: Draft v0.5 – Refinement & Realism Upgrade

Purpose: Real-World Coordination Under Systemic Stress

0. Revision Note (v0.5)

This revision addresses targeted refinements identified in v0.4 review:

- **Narrative fragmentation metric** complemented by direct community trust surveys
 - **Constrained coordination mode** concretely defined
 - **Rapid Narrative Assembly fallback** specified for crisis conditions
 - **Domain Adaptation Protocol** strengthened with external stakeholder involvement
 - **Complexity acknowledgment** with commitment to future simplification review
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1. Honest Framing: The Coordination Spectrum

1.1 Acknowledging Soft Power

ACP is **voluntary** in the sense that no state is legally compelled to join or comply with **allocation proposals**. However, it employs **soft power mechanisms**—transparency,

reputation, access to benefits—that create incentives for participation and costs for defection.

These mechanisms exist on a spectrum:

Mechanism	Description	Nature
Transparency	Public visibility of commitments and compliance.	Soft accountability. States may experience reputational pressure but retain full sovereignty over actions.
Tiered Benefits	Access to ERF, data, and coordination support scaled by participation level.	Conditional cooperation. Benefits are earned through engagement; non-participation means foregoing opportunities, not facing sanctions.
Exclusion from Benefits	Observing Partners receive reduced or no access to certain ACP resources.	Boundary-setting. The system protects its integrity by limiting free-riding, not by punishing.
Documentation of Disruption	Public logging of actions that actively undermine coordination.	Truth-telling. The system names behavior without imposing penalties, leaving consequences to political and diplomatic channels.
Referral to Multilateral Bodies	In extreme cases, patterns of disruption may be reported to existing institutions (e.g., UN).	Leveraging existing structures. ACP does not create new enforcement powers.

ACP does not resolve the tension between voluntary coordination and the need for system integrity. It **manages** this tension through graduated, transparent mechanisms that preserve sovereignty while protecting the commons.

2. ERF Governance (Detailed Specification)

2.1 Capitalization

2.1.1 Seed Funding (Phase 1)

Initial ERF capitalization comes from:

- **Voluntary contributions** from founding ACP participants, with a **non-binding guidance** scaled to GDP (e.g., 0.001% of GDP as a suggested minimum).
- **Multilateral seed grants** (e.g., UN CERF, World Bank trust funds).
- **Philanthropic bridge funding** restricted to the first 24 months.

2.1.2 Sustained Capitalization (Phase 2+)

- A **progressive contribution formula** is adopted by the Participant Assembly, based on capacity and historical crisis exposure.
- Contributions are **pledged annually** with public reporting.
- A **minimum viable fund threshold** is established (e.g., sufficient to cover 30 days of Emergency Mode operations). If the fund falls below this threshold, the Participant Assembly is convened to address the shortfall.

2.1.3 Shortfall Protocol (Updated)

If contributions are insufficient to meet Emergency Mode demands:

1. The ACP Secretariat notifies all Core and Cooperating Partners.
2. A **special pledging round** is initiated with a 7-day window.
3. If shortfall persists, the Allocation Engine adjusts proposals to reflect available resources, and the system operates in a **"constrained coordination" mode**.

Constrained Coordination Mode – Operational Definition:

When ERF resources fall below the minimum viable threshold, the following adjustments take effect:

- **First priority:** Direct life-saving assistance (emergency shelter, food, medical care) is protected. All other funding streams are subject to proportional reduction.
- **Second priority:** Frontline state stabilization funding is reduced by a predefined percentage (e.g., 25%), with the understanding that this may increase pressure on those states and potentially accelerate onward movement.
- **Deprioritized:** Long-term integration support, capacity-building programs, and non-essential administrative functions are suspended until the fund is replenished.
- **Transparency:** A public notice is issued on the ACP dashboard stating: *"ACP is operating in Constrained Coordination Mode. Available resources are insufficient to meet all commitments. The following categories are currently deprioritized: [list]."*

These adjustments are **pre-announced and standardized**, not determined ad hoc during crisis.

2.2 Disbursement Governance

2.2.1 Approval Body

The **ERF Disbursement Panel** consists of **7 rotating members**:

- 2 from frontline/transit states
- 2 from destination states
- 2 from contributing states (non-frontline, non-destination)
- 1 independent expert (appointed by the Participant Assembly)

Rotation occurs every 12 months, with staggered terms to ensure continuity.

2.2.2 Decision Rules

- **Automatic disbursements** (pre-authorized Emergency Mode envelope): No panel approval required; funds released within 48 hours.
- **Expedited disbursements** (> 30% of fund or > \$X million): Panel approval required within 72 hours, with a **simple majority** decision.
- **Standard disbursements:** Panel approval within 7 days, with **qualified majority (5/7)**.

2.2.3 Transparency and Appeal

- All disbursement decisions are published with rationale within 24 hours.
- Affected states may appeal a denial to the **Peer Mediation Panel**, which issues a non-binding recommendation within 7 days.

2.3 Secretariat Accountability and Oversight

Rationale: The ACP Secretariat holds significant operational authority. Mechanisms are required to detect and address potential capture, bad faith, or persistent underperformance by the Secretariat itself.

2.3.1 ACP Ombudsperson

- An independent **ACP Ombudsperson** is appointed by the Participant Assembly for a **single, non-renewable 4-year term**.
- **Mandate:** To receive and investigate confidential complaints regarding Secretariat conduct, including allegations of bias, data manipulation, favoritism, or procedural violations.
- **Access:** Any participant state, accredited civil society organization, or Community Reflection Circle may submit a complaint.
- **Reporting:** The Ombudsperson issues a **public annual report** summarizing investigations and recommendations. Urgent matters may be reported directly to the Participant Assembly at any time.

2.3.2 External Audit Trigger

- Any **three (3) Core Partners** acting jointly may trigger an **extraordinary external audit** of the Secretariat's operations, finances, or data integrity.
- The audit is conducted by an independent body (e.g., a multinational audit firm or UN Office of Internal Oversight Services) selected by the Peer Mediation Panel.
- Findings are presented to the Participant Assembly within 60 days and made public (with appropriate redactions for sensitive information).

2.3.3 No-Confidence Process

- If the Ombudsperson's report or an external audit identifies **systemic misconduct or gross negligence**, a motion of no-confidence in the Secretariat leadership may be introduced in the Participant Assembly.

- Passage requires a **two-thirds majority** of Core and Cooperating Partners.
 - Upon passage, the Participant Assembly shall initiate a **leadership transition process** within 30 days.
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3. Pluralistic Narrative Infrastructure

3.1 Principle: Narrative as Co-Creation, Not Management

The v0.3 framing of "narrative support triggered upon activation" risked treating public narrative as a top-down communications function. v0.4 repositions narrative infrastructure as a **pluralistic, participatory process**.

3.2 ACP Narrative Commons

3.2.1 During Normal Mode

- The ACP dashboard includes an open **"Voices from the Corridor"** section, aggregating perspectives from frontline communities, civil society, and local media (curated for relevance, not editorial control).
- **Narrative Stewardship Guilds** (per Meaning Infrastructure Protocol) are invited to document and share stories of coordination and its challenges, independent of ACP Secretariat oversight.

3.2.2 Upon Stress/Emergency Mode Activation

- A **Rapid Narrative Assembly** is convened within 72 hours, comprising:
 - Representatives from affected communities (**selected via sortition where feasible**)
 - Local journalists and cultural practitioners
 - ACP Secretariat (observer only)

Fallback When Sortition Is Not Feasible:

In acute crisis conditions where sortition is impractical (e.g., active conflict, displaced populations in transit, lack of communication infrastructure), the following fallback applies:

1. The ACP Secretariat, in consultation with the **Peer Mediation Panel**, identifies **3–5 trusted civil society organizations or community-based networks** already operating in the affected area.
 2. These organizations are invited to **nominate representatives** to the Rapid Narrative Assembly, with a mandate to reflect the diversity of affected voices (including marginalized groups).
 3. The composition of the Assembly and the selection process are **transparently documented** on the ACP dashboard, including an explicit statement when sortition was not feasible and why.
- The Assembly produces a "**Living Narrative Brief**" —a plain-language, evolving document that explains the crisis and coordination efforts from multiple perspectives. This brief is **not a single official story** but a **container for diverse voices**.
 - The brief is updated weekly and translated into regional languages.

3.2.3 Community Reflection Circles

- These occur **during and after** crisis response, not only post-escalation.
- Findings are fed back into the Narrative Brief and into protocol refinement via the Participant Assembly.

4. Due Process for "Disruptive Actor" Categorization

4.1 Principle

Labeling a state or actor as "Disruptive" has significant diplomatic and operational consequences. The process must be fair, transparent, and subject to appeal.

4.2 Designation Process

4.2.1 Evidence Gathering

- The ACP Secretariat compiles a **documented pattern of behavior** (e.g., evidence of weaponizing migration flows, active obstruction of coordination, disinformation campaigns).
- Evidence must be **corroborated by at least two independent sources** (e.g., UN agencies, regional bodies, accredited NGOs).

4.2.2 Notification and Response Period

- The actor in question receives a **formal notification** with the evidence and a **30-day period** to respond or remedy the behavior.
- During this period, the actor is classified as **"Under Review."**

4.2.3 Designation Decision

- After 30 days, the **Peer Mediation Panel** reviews the evidence and the actor's response.
- Designation as **"Disruptive Actor"** requires a **consensus decision** of the Panel.
- The designation is **time-limited** (e.g., 6 months) and subject to quarterly review.

4.2.4 Appeal

- The designated actor may appeal to the **Participant Assembly**, which can overturn the designation by a **two-thirds majority**.

4.3 Transparency

- All designations, evidence summaries (with appropriate sensitivity), and responses are published on the ACP dashboard.
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5. Domain Transferability

5.1 Acknowledgment

ACP emerged from migration-focused simulations. Its mechanisms are **not universally applicable without adaptation**. v0.5 explicitly acknowledges this.

5.2 Domain Adaptation Protocol (Updated)

Before ACP is deployed in a new domain (e.g., climate finance, pandemic response, AI disruption), a **Domain Adaptation Review** is conducted:

1. **Stakeholder Mapping:** Identify key actors, incentives, and existing coordination mechanisms in the new domain.
2. **Mechanism Audit:** Assess which ACP components transfer cleanly and which require modification.
3. **Pilot Design:** Develop a domain-specific pilot with adjusted thresholds, allocation factors, and narrative infrastructure.
4. **External Stakeholder Involvement:** For genuinely new domains where no Participant Assembly yet exists, the review process **SHALL** include **external domain experts and representatives of affected communities** as non-voting advisors. Their input is documented and considered in the adaptation design.
5. **Participant Assembly Approval:** Once a domain-specific Assembly is constituted, the adapted protocol is submitted for formal approval.

This ensures that domain adaptation is not a closed, self-referential process.

5.3 Example: Climate Finance vs. Migration

ACP Component	Migration Applicability	Climate Finance Applicability	Adaptation Needed
SAL	High (flows, capacities)	Medium (funding flows, project impacts)	Different data sources; slower tempo
Allocation Engine	High (redistribution of people)	Low (allocation of funds is different)	Replace with transparent funding allocation criteria
ERF	High (rapid frontline support)	High (rapid climate disaster response)	Similar mechanism, different triggers
Narrative Infrastructure	High	High	Similar principles, different framing

6. Measurable Success Indicators

6.1 Operationalized Metrics

Success Criterion	Indicator	Measurement Method	Baseline/Target
Rapid financial response	Time from Emergency Mode activation to first ERF disbursement	ERF transaction logs	Target: < 72 hours
Improved mid-level compliance	% of Cooperating Partners meeting ≥70% of commitments	Contribution Registry	Target: Increase from baseline (TBD in pilot)
Coherent public narrative (structural)	Reduction in narrative fragmentation score	Media monitoring (e.g., topic modeling across outlets)	Target: 20% reduction in fragmentation during crisis vs. pre-ACP baseline
Coherent public narrative (trust-based)	Community trust in coordination efforts	Annual trust survey of affected populations (stratified random sample; includes questions on perceived fairness, transparency, and whether coordination is understood)	Target: ≥60% reporting "coordination efforts are fair and understandable"
External actor containment	Number of documented disruptive actions by designated actors	Secretariat log; independent verification	Target: Decreasing trend over 12-month periods
Transparent trust tracking	Contribution Registry update frequency and accuracy	Audit of registry against actual flows	Target: 100% of commitments updated within 7 days of reporting period
Participant satisfaction	Annual survey of Participant	Structured questionnaire	Target: ≥70% reporting "ACP improves"

Success Criterion	Indicator	Measurement Method	Baseline/Target
	Assembly members		coordination outcomes"

Note on Narrative Metrics: The fragmentation score measures structural discourse coherence; the community trust survey measures lived perception. Both are necessary; neither is sufficient alone.

6.2 Qualitative Assessment

In addition to quantitative metrics, an annual **Qualitative Impact Review** is conducted, incorporating:

- Community Reflection Circle summaries
- Narrative Brief analysis
- Case studies of specific crisis responses

This review is published alongside quantitative metrics.

7. Complexity Acknowledgment and Simplification Commitment

7.1 Acknowledgment

As ACP has matured through iterative revision, its specification has grown in detail and complexity. This is a natural consequence of addressing real-world implementation challenges. However, complexity imposes costs:

- Implementation friction for smaller or lower-capacity states
- Accessibility barriers for non-specialist audiences

- Increased surface area for legalistic gaming of rules

7.2 Simplification Review

ACP commits to a **periodic simplification review**, conducted every **two years** by the Participant Assembly. The review asks:

What is the minimum viable version of each mechanism that achieves the core coordination goal?

The review may result in:

- Streamlining of procedural steps
- Consolidation of overlapping functions
- Removal of mechanisms that have proven unnecessary or unused

The outcome of each simplification review is published as a **Simplification Report**, and any resulting protocol changes follow the standard amendment process.

8. Updated Risk Profile

Risk	v0.5 Mitigation
Perception of coercion	Honest framing of soft power spectrum; transparency of all mechanisms
ERF undercapitalization	Shortfall protocol with clearly defined constrained coordination priorities
Narrative capture	Pluralistic Narrative Commons; sortition with documented fallback
Unfair "Disruptive" labeling	Due process with evidence, response period, peer review, and appeal
Domain mismatch	Domain Adaptation Protocol with external stakeholder involvement
Unmeasurable success	Operationalized indicators with baselines and targets, including community trust surveys
Complexity burden	Biennial simplification review commitment

9. Strategic Insight (v0.5)

This revision addresses the "last mile" of accountability and realism. The protocol now:

- **Defines what happens when resources are scarce** (constrained coordination mode)
- **Provides a credible fallback for narrative inclusion** when ideal sortition is impossible
- **Ensures domain adaptation is not an insular process** by involving external stakeholders
- **Commits to periodic simplification** to counter the natural drift toward complexity

The protocol is now ready for external practitioner review and pilot partner engagement.

10. Conclusion

ACP v0.5 is a **refinement release**. It does not introduce new structural components but strengthens the weak points identified in v0.4 review. The protocol is now:

- **Honest** about its power dynamics
- **Accountable** in its processes
- **Pluralistic** in its narrative infrastructure
- **Realistic** about resource constraints
- **Humble** about domain applicability
- **Committed** to managing its own complexity

Next Steps:

- Seek external review from migration coordination practitioners
 - Identify a first-mover pilot partner (UN OCHA, EU, African Union)
 - Develop a simplified "ACP Lite" one-pager for initial stakeholder conversations
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